

Security Experience Highlights

Securing a Small Network and SOP Writing

While interning at Wenatchee Valley College's Help Desk, I supported a small network of student and staff devices across multiple buildings. I helped troubleshoot connectivity issues, assisted with patching routines, and documented recurring problems. To improve consistency, I drafted a basic SOP for handling common support tickets covering steps for browser resets, network adapter checks, and access permission reviews. This guide helped reduce repeat issues and gave new interns a clear starting point for triage. Later, during my SOC internship, I expanded this mindset by reviewing logs in Kibana and contributing to incident ticket documentation.

Threat Modeling a Home Network

To strengthen my cybersecurity fundamentals, I applied threat modeling to my own home network. I identified key assets like my laptop, router, and smart devices, then mapped out potential threats such as unauthorized access and phishing. I documented risks and mitigation strategies, such as changing default credentials, enabling logging, and enforcing MFA across all accounts. I used Wireshark to inspect traffic and practiced log review techniques to simulate real-world monitoring. This hands-on setup became a learning lab I use to reinforce basic security hygiene and build confidence with network analysis tools.

Comfort with Networking and Security Fundamentals

In my Help Desk and SOC roles, I've steadily built confidence with core networking and security concepts. I've used basic TCP/IP knowledge like checking IP configurations, verifying connectivity with ping and traceroute, and identifying DNS issues to troubleshoot access problems. I've learned how VLANs are used to segment traffic and practiced interpreting logs in tools like Kibana. I've also supported MFA rollouts in Microsoft 365 and followed least privilege principles when managing user access. These experiences have helped me connect classroom learning to real-world environments, and I continue to build on them through hands-on labs and personal projects.

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